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Graduate Recruitment Team

TP ICAP

135 Bishopsgate

London EC2M 3TP

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Energy & Commodities Trainee Broker Graduate Programme in London, with a particular interest in gas and power broking. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. TP ICAP's Energy and Commodities business grew revenue to £233 million in the first half of 2026 despite a sharp fall in oil futures volumes in the second quarter, which shows the value of a broker's network when markets are disrupted.

Much of my work centres on commodity markets. My dissertation, supervised by Dr Luigi Gifuni, tests whether governments that hedge oil change how their currencies react to OPEC news: whether Norway's krone conversions, Russia's 2017–22 budget rule and Mexico's put hedge make the oil beta smaller, kinked or one-sided, and whether any beta that remains can be traded after costs. As co-founder of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, which I grew to 126 members, I built a wheat calendar-spread strategy in R from futures curve structure and CFTC Commitments of Traders positioning, and published weekly research notes for members.

Sales and trading appeals to me because it joins analysis to a live price and to a client who needs a clear answer quickly. Writing those weekly notes taught me to turn analysis into a view that non-specialists can act on. In nearly two years at KONG, I learned that a recommendation lands only when it fits the person hearing it: by analysing sales patterns and refining our upselling prompts, I raised average customer spend by an estimated 25%. I also take risk seriously: at the Strathclyde Poker Society, where I was Vice-President and then President, I taught new members to use the Kelly criterion to work out how many buy-ins their own win rate, variance and appetite for risk call for.

TP ICAP stands out to me because, as the world's largest inter-dealer broker, it sits at the centre of the energy markets I study, and its graduate programme gives trainees on-the-job learning across Energy and Commodities products before a permanent placement. Broking rewards fast, accurate judgement and trusted relationships, and I would bring a working knowledge of oil-market fundamentals, from OPEC decisions to the currencies they move, to desks where clients expect a broker to understand the market they are trading.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan